New Zealand Police

Disability and Special Considerations Flag

Frequently Asked Questions

NEW ZEALAND POLICE
Ngā Pirihimana o Aotearoa

Disability and special considerations flag

Sometimes police are called to events where people have a disability. Some disabilities can impact the person's ability to communicate clearly or explain their situation to police, especially when under stress.

The Disability and Special Considerations Flag was created to provide Police with important information about a person's needs.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I have to record my disability information with Police?

No. Recording disability information in this with Police is voluntary.

Why should I record disability information with Police?

It will help Police to engage with the person, because recording the information is one way for Police to provide tailored help, where possible.

What information is recorded and by who?

The information provided should include what police need to know when interacting with the person. This could include how they communicate, if they use any devices, or if they have any behaviours they want Police to understand, including what those behaviours mean and why they happen.

What if the disabled person is under 16 years old?

For a person aged under 16 years, the parent or guardian can consent to a Flag, noting it expires when the young person turns 16. The person will then be contacted directly by Police, unless advised otherwise, to ask if they want and consent to the Flag to continue.

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How will the information in the Flag be used and can this information be shared?

Your information is treated confidentially. It will be stored securely and only used when it is either required or authorized by law.

Can a ‘Disability and Special Considerations Flag’ be recorded without me knowing?

The only time a Flag can be used without the disabled person’s informed consent is when a parent or guardian requests Flag on their behalf.

When is informed consent required?

Informed consent must be given when a Flag is recorded by a person so they are aware and understand where and how the information is being recorded and used.

Why do Police need to know about someone’s disability information?

The Flag documents what the person wants Police to know in an emergency or when there is a chance encounter (e.g., a traffic stop). The Flag makes it easier to communicate and understand the person’s needs.

Can this information be used against me if I get stopped by Police?

No. The purpose of the Flag is to help Police communicate and engage more effectively with those in the disability community.

What do I need to do to have a Disability and Special Considerations flag recorded?

Contact 105 to request disability information is recorded in a “Disability and Special Considerations Flag”. From 1 May 2026 you can also complete an online form on the 105 website (www.police.govt.nz/use-105)



What is going to help us, help you?

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What other information do I need to provide to Police to have a Flag started or updated?

Police will need the person's full name, address, and date of birth, so information is linked to the correct person. Also, include the relevant disability details that would help Police during an encounter with the person and a form of identification to confirm identity.

Are there generic Flags or are they individualised and just about me?

The Flag is individual to the person and their disability information.

Why has Police introduced the 'Disability and Special Considerations Flag'?

Police and disabled people have indicated that they want police to know about a person's disability before they interact with police. It allows police to adjust their approach. For example, an officer might need to understand a person's physical boundaries or how touching the person could trigger rather than comfort them. Having this information leads to better and safer outcomes for everyone involved.

How does this improve outcomes for those in the community?

When police know more about a person's needs, they can adjust how they approach and communicate with them and avoid potential triggers for that person, when appropriate or available to do so.

What if I change my mind and I do not want a Flag, or I need to change something?

Flags can be withdrawn anytime by speaking with Police or contacting 105. Details can also be amended and updated.